the Allies east into Egypt and the Allies pushed the Axis powers back into Libya. The further one armed force came, the further its supply lines were extended and the easier it was for the other to fight back. One thorn in Germany’s side was the Mediterranean island of Malta, from where British forces constantly disrupted the German stream of provisions coming from Italy to Tripoli. Despite the serious shelling, Hitler's efforts eventually came to an end. England's King George VI granted the island the George Cross.

In June 1942, the British dug themselves in the little Egyptian town of El Alamein that was sixty miles west of Alexandria. Meanwhile, the Germans were 1,400 miles from Tripoli. In July 1942, the principal clash of El Alamein occurred and finished in stalemate. The second fight was driven by Field Marshal Bernard Montgomery, or 'Monty', who brought about a Commonwealth triumph. Rommel was pushed back a tiny bit at a time because his supplies were running out. Eventually, the British under the command of Montgomery were able to recapture Tobruk on the 13th of November.

In October 1942, English infantry progressed amid the skirmish of El Alamein. New British and American forces had arrived towards the west in North Africa, Morocco and Algeria. They met the Vichy French in the region who surrendered after just three days. Hitler saw their surrender as trickery and reacted by sending men to the Vichy controlled part of France. Montgomery's men caught Tripoli in January 1943 and after two months made the Germans move westwards into Tunisia. On the 9th of March, Rommel was called back home and the Allies ruptured the braced Tunisian-Libyan fringe. The Germans were effectively pushed into Tunis.

The Germans finally surrendered on May 13th 1943. The Allied triumph in North Africa incited Churchill to state: ‘This is not the end, nor is it even the beginning of the end, but it is, perhaps, the end of the beginning.’